

MODEL UNITED NATIONS

PROFESSIONAL STUDY GUIDE

Agenda: The Issue of the Strait of Hormuz

The Strait of Hormuz remains one of the most strategically significant waterways in the world. Serving as a major global energy corridor, the region is central to international trade, maritime security, and geopolitical stability. This study guide has been professionally prepared to assist delegates in understanding the political, economic, legal, and security dimensions surrounding the issue.

"Diplomacy is the art of balancing national interests with international peace."

Committee Overview

The committee will examine tensions, maritime disputes, military activities, sanctions, freedom of navigation, energy security, and regional diplomacy concerning the Strait of Hormuz. Delegates are expected to debate in a formal MUN setting while proposing practical and diplomatic solutions.

Understanding the Strait of Hormuz

The Strait of Hormuz is a narrow maritime passage connecting the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea. Approximately one-fifth of the world's petroleum passes through this waterway, making it critical for the global economy. The surrounding states include Iran, Oman, the United Arab Emirates, and other Gulf nations whose economies are heavily dependent upon maritime energy exports.

Historical Background

The strategic significance of the Strait increased dramatically after the oil boom of the 20th century. Tensions intensified during the Iran-Iraq War (1980–1988), especially during the "Tanker War," where oil tankers were attacked. In recent decades, disputes between Iran and Western powers, sanctions, naval patrols, and regional rivalries have repeatedly threatened stability in the region.

Key Issues in Debate

- Freedom of navigation and maritime law under UNCLOS.
- Regional security and naval militarization.
- Economic dependency on oil transportation.
- Sanctions and their impact on maritime trade.
- Risks of military escalation between Iran and Western allies.
- Energy security for importing nations.
- Environmental risks in the Gulf region.

Relevant International Law

Delegates should understand the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS), which protects freedom of navigation through international straits. The debate may also involve the principles of sovereignty, self-defense, sanctions law, and international maritime security agreements.

Delegates may consider confidence-building measures, regional security dialogues, de-escalation agreements, joint naval patrols, international mediation, maritime monitoring mechanisms, economic cooperation frameworks, and diplomatic negotiations under the UN.

Debate Tips for Delegates

1. Maintain formal diplomatic language at all times.
2. Focus on your country's national interests and alliances.
3. Avoid emotional arguments; remain policy-oriented.
4. Build alliances and draft practical resolutions.
5. Balance security concerns with international cooperation.

Country Matrix & Foreign Policy Positions

Country	Foreign Policy Position
Türkiye	Supports freedom of navigation while balancing strong regional diplomacy and economic interests.
United Arab Emirates	Advocates maritime stability and secure oil transportation routes while opposing regional tensions.
Russian Federation	Opposes Western military dominance and supports strategic cooperation with Iran.
Germany	Supports diplomacy, sanctions compliance, and protection of international trade routes.
China	Prioritizes uninterrupted energy imports and peaceful diplomatic resolution.
Pakistan	Promotes regional stability, neutrality, and peaceful negotiation among Gulf states.
Saudi Arabia	Seeks strong security arrangements against Iranian threats and protection of oil exports.
Yemen	Affected by regional conflict dynamics and maritime insecurity in surrounding waters.
United Kingdom	Supports international naval security operations and freedom of navigation.
Oman	Encourages neutrality, mediation, and peaceful Gulf diplomacy.
Qatar	Supports regional dialogue and balanced diplomatic engagement.
Kuwait	Advocates Gulf security cooperation and regional economic stability.
Iraq	Calls for regional de-escalation due to economic and security vulnerabilities.
United States of America	Maintains strong naval presence to secure international shipping lanes.
India	Strongly concerned with energy security and uninterrupted oil imports.
Bahrain	Supports Gulf Cooperation Council security initiatives.
Japan	Advocates stability due to heavy reliance on Middle Eastern energy imports.
France	Supports international maritime security missions and diplomatic solutions.
Lebanon	Encourages peaceful diplomacy while balancing regional political pressures.
Syria	Supports Iranian strategic interests and opposes Western intervention.
Israel	Views Iranian regional influence and military activity as a security concern.
Iran	Emphasizes sovereignty and opposes foreign military intervention in regional waters.
South Korea	Supports freedom of navigation because of dependence on Gulf energy imports.
Jordan	Promotes moderation, regional peace, and multilateral diplomacy.

Sample Resolution Focus Areas

Delegates may draft resolutions concerning:

- Maritime security cooperation mechanisms.
- Creation of an international monitoring mission.
- Diplomatic dialogue between Gulf states and global powers.
- Reduction of military escalation in the region.
- Protection of energy supply chains.
- Humanitarian and environmental protection measures.
- Strengthening international maritime law compliance.

Final Advice for Delegates

Successful delegates combine strong research, diplomacy, confidence, negotiation, and professionalism. Understanding your country's strategic interests while also cooperating internationally is essential for producing effective resolutions in committee. Focus on realistic and implementable solutions that promote peace, stability, and international cooperation.

Prepared for Model United Nations Delegates